

SCALES SUCK, THE END.

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #200

I am going to end the Digging Deeper Jazz series the way I began it 200 weeks ago. By making the point that scales are NOT the best path to jazz improvisation success for most of us, most of the time. Should you practice scales on your instrument? Yes. Can we use scales as a basis for improvisation? Sure. Are they the best point of departure. Definitely not.

Chord tones, on the other hand, do NOT suck. They are great, and they are your goal. Most melodies, and most great jazz solos are comprised mostly of chord tones. No exaggeration. 70% + chord tones, almost without exception. Be like your heroes, and put down the scales.

Get good with 1) chord tones, 2) anticipations, 3) neighboring notes, and 4) passing notes.

#1 - Solo/Etude over "My Shining Hour"

The musical score is written in 4/4 time and features four staves of music. Chord symbols are placed above the staves, with arrows indicating specific notes in the melody. The first staff shows Cmaj7, Am7, Dm7, and G7. The second staff shows Cmaj7, Am7, Dm7, Bø7, and E7(b9). The third staff shows Am7, Bø7, and E7(b9). The fourth staff shows Am7, D7, Dm7, and G7. Labels below the staves identify specific notes: (anticipation) for the first and last notes of the first staff; (neighbor tone) for the first note of the second staff; (passing tone) for the first note of the third staff; (neighbor tone) for the second note of the third staff; (anticipation) for the third note of the third staff; (anticipations) for the last two notes of the second staff; and (yes, a scale!) for the last two notes of the fourth staff.

CHORD TONE ETUDE

BASED ON "MY SHINING HOUR" - 85% CHORD TONES

A *C*maj7 *A*m7 *D*m7 *G*7

5 *C*maj7 *A*m7 *D*m7 *B*ø7 *E*7(♭9)

B 9 *A*m7 *B*ø7 *E*7(♭9)

13 *A*m7 *D*7 *D*m7 *G*7

C 17 *G*m7 *C*7(♭9) *F*maj7

21 *F*m7 *B*♭7 *C*6/*E* *E*♭ø7 *D*m7 *G*7

D 25 *C*maj7 *C*maj7 *D*m7 *E*m7 *A*7(♭9)

29 *D*m7 *G*7 *C*maj7

TENOR SAX/TRUMPET

JEFF ANTONIUK

CHORD TONE ETUDE

BASED ON "MY SHINING HOUR" - 85% CHORD TONES

A

1 Dmaj7 Bm7 Em7 A7

5 Dmaj7 Bm7 Em7 C#ø7 F#7(b9)

B

9 Bm7 C#ø7 F#7(b9)

13 Bm7 E7 Em7 A7

C

17 Am7 D7(b9) Gmaj7

21 Gm7 C7 D6/F# Fø7 Em7 A7

D

25 Dmaj7 Dmaj7 Em7 F#m7 B7(b9)

29 Em7 A7 Dmaj7

CHORD TONE ETUDE

BASED ON "MY SHINING HOUR" - 85% CHORD TONES

A

Amaj7 F#m7 Bm7 E7

5 Amaj7 F#m7 Bm7 G#ø7 C#7(b9)

B

9 F#m7 G#ø7 C#7(b9)

13 F#m7 B7 Bm7 E7

C

17 Em7 A7(b9) Dmaj7

21 Dm7 G7 A6/C# Cø7 Bm7 E7

D

25 Amaj7 Amaj7 Bm7 C#m7 F#7(b9)

29 Bm7 E7 Amaj7

CHORD TONE ETUDE

BASED ON "MY SHINING HOUR" - 85% CHORD TONES

A

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

B

13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24

C

25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 33 34 35 36 37 38 39 40 41 42 43 44 45 46 47 48 49 50 51 52 53 54 55 56 57 58 59 60 61 62 63 64 65 66 67 68 69 70 71 72 73 74 75 76 77 78 79 80 81 82 83 84 85 86 87 88 89 90 91 92 93 94 95 96 97 98 99 100

D

101 102 103 104 105 106 107 108 109 110 111 112 113 114 115 116 117 118 119 120 121 122 123 124 125 126 127 128 129 130 131 132 133 134 135 136 137 138 139 140 141 142 143 144 145 146 147 148 149 150 151 152 153 154 155 156 157 158 159 160 161 162 163 164 165 166 167 168 169 170 171 172 173 174 175 176 177 178 179 180 181 182 183 184 185 186 187 188 189 190 191 192 193 194 195 196 197 198 199 200